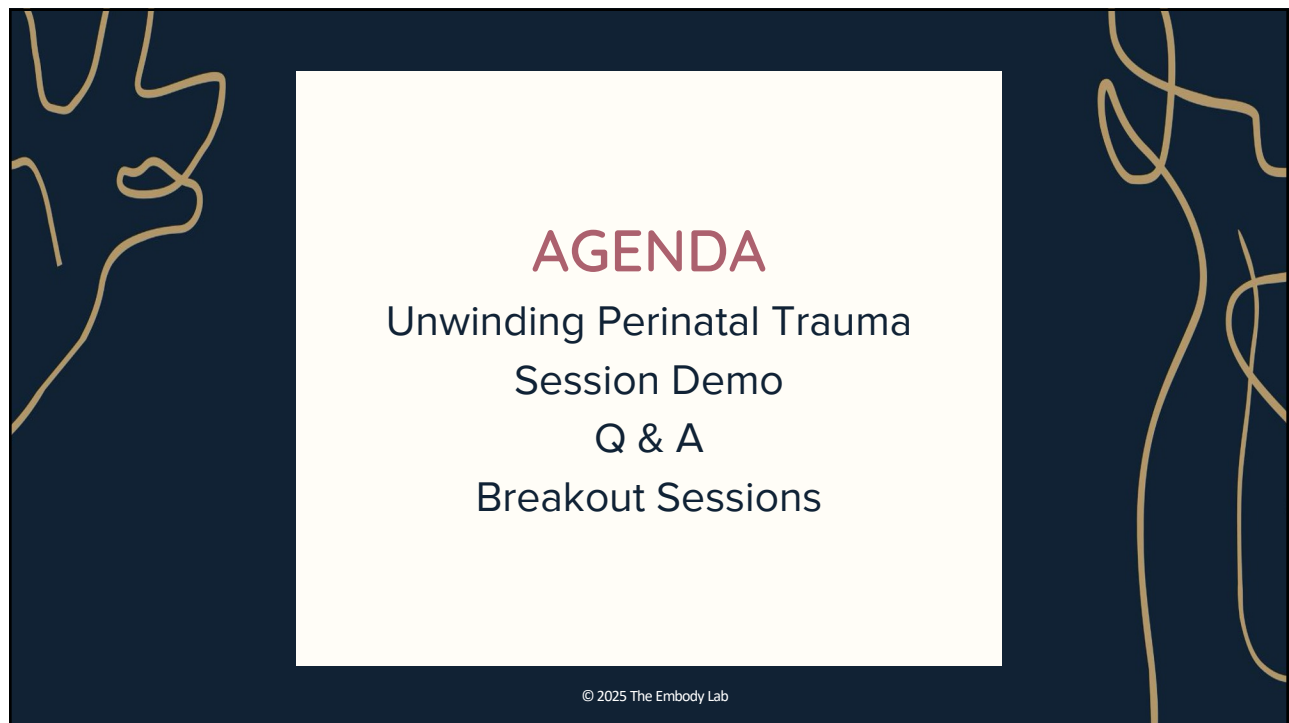




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2

Reflect & Regulate

Reflect (5-point Check-in):

- Mind
- Body
- Breath
- Emotions
- Energy

Regulate:

- Listen to your Experience
- Offer Compassion (from self or other)
- Deepen (Breathe into Sensations)
- Respond (Movement, Sound, Gesture)
- Receive any New Experience

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Unwinding Perinatal Trauma

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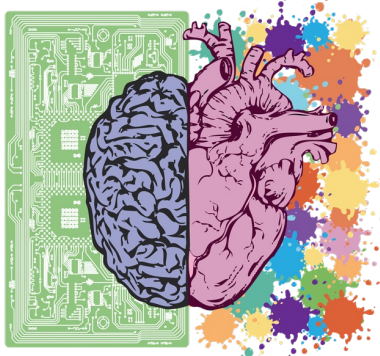
Perinatal Patterns

- Being emotionally welcome into life
- Being Seen & protected
- A protected entry into life where existence itself feels safe enough
- Primordial/primal freeze: shutdown of brain, body, and developmental sequencing
- Birth trauma (complications, C-section impact, invasive medical interventions, incubator time)
- Extended separation, neglect, or postpartum depression in caregiver
- Somatic presentation: frozen core, joint/muscle tension, infant dissociation, dysregulated nervous system, interrupted development, global mistrust
- Core need: It is safe for me to exist & I am welcome here, it's safe to be embodied
- Common NCs: "I shouldn't exist," "I am not wanted," "I cannot trust the world," "I do not belong," "my body is not safe."

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Preverbal Memories



- **Implicit Memory:** Dominant from birth until age 3, provide the foundation for a **felt sense** of self, stored as representations of motor patterns and sensations.
- **Explicit Memory:** Knowledge of facts, time, and place. Provides basis for a **verbal narrative** that helps us develop a coherent sense of self across time.
- **Preverbal Memories:** Earliest attachment memories that exist prior to age 3. Amygdala online at birth. Brain structures (hippocampus, prefrontal cortex) necessary for explicit verbal memories develop later.

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Psychobiological Regulation and Implicit Memory

- Our earliest memories are neither verbal nor stored as images.
- They are motor patterns and sensations.
- These blueprints of our earliest relationships present as psychophysiological arousal and emotion.
- The mother or caregiver provides external regulation for a child's immature physiology (Schore, 2001).
- The mother's autonomic nervous system, which includes vagal tone, influences the infant's physiology.
- These early influences on the child's nervous system have been demonstrated to have a long-lasting impact on later self-regulatory capacity (Bornstein & Suess, 2000).



7

Interpersonal Neurobiology

The therapist acts as an external psychobiological regulator by attuning to client's arousal states and modeling self-regulation (Schore, 2012)

Interventions for Psychobiological Regulation

- Connect to social engagement system (therapist and client)
- Focus on present orientation and safety
- Proximity awareness (Facing, Spacing, Pacing)
- Sensory interventions
- Conscious use of eye contact
- Conscious use of voice tone
- Movement interventions



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Embedded Relational Mindfulness

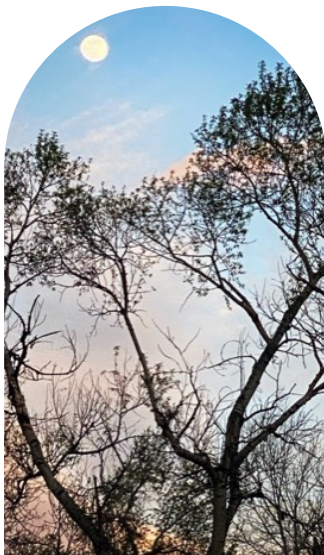


Sensorimotor Psychotherapy (Ogden & Minton, 2006)

- Relational Alchemy: The uniqueness of each dyad and each gathering is an expression of the here and now relationship.
- Embedded Relational Mindfulness: Therapist & client together mindfully study the embodied relational experience that emerges during therapy. Observe for changes in:
 - Eye contact
 - Breathing
 - Posture
 - Movement/Gesture
 - Heart rate
 - Muscle tone
 - Facial Expressions
 - Voice tone/Prosody
 - Swallowing
 - Alertness

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Co-Regulation



The greatest predictor of meaningful change is the quality of the therapeutic alliance (Courtois & Pearlman, 2005).

- **Interpersonal Co-Regulation:** The ability to be in ventral vagal regulation and offer that regulating energy to others.
- **A Shared Window of Tolerance:** Clinician's use of breath, affect tolerance, and embodiment offers modeling and communicates a willingness to "be with" distress
- **Co-Regulation precedes Self-Regulation**
- **Intrapersonal Co-Regulation:** Self-regulation through the internal connection between breath, heart, brain, and embodied connection

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Practice: Co-Regulation

- **Therapist Self-Awareness:** Mind, Body, Breath, Emotions, Energy
- **Observe Client's Presentation:** Mind, Body, Breath, Emotions, Energy
- **Offer your Awareness:** Compassionately reflect your observations, "I notice..."
- **Reflect & Accept:** Before offering interventions to change or regulate the client's experience offer your understanding of the symptom in context. Validate and nonjudgmentally accept them as they are.
- **Explore Regulation in Relationship:** Honor cycles of engagement & disengagement, adjust eye contact, voice tone, proximity, safe mobilization & safe immobilization

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Session Structure (Growth Edge)

- **Orienting to the space and cues of safety**
- **5 point check in:** notice your nervous system
- **Identify an intention for the session**
- **Meet your nervous system where you are:** Sensing what is present for you, is there a shape for your body that would best support you right now? How do you know? As you arrive in this shape, allow yourself to fine-tune, listen, adjust and adapt.
- **Sensing your own readiness for change and the "growth edge of yourself"**
- **Is there a shape that represents your growth edge?**
- **Sense what holds you back, notice the fears or barriers to moving into your full potential.**
- **Is there a shape that represents the barriers or fears? How is this feeling familiar? How and when have you felt this way in the past? what does this part of you need?**
- **Move between these shapes...trusting yourself**
- **This is a conversation between you and your body.**
- **When you feel a sense of completion or resolution for this process for you, take a few minutes in stillness to integrate, receive, and absorb this process. (Golden Nugget)**

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The Golden Nugget

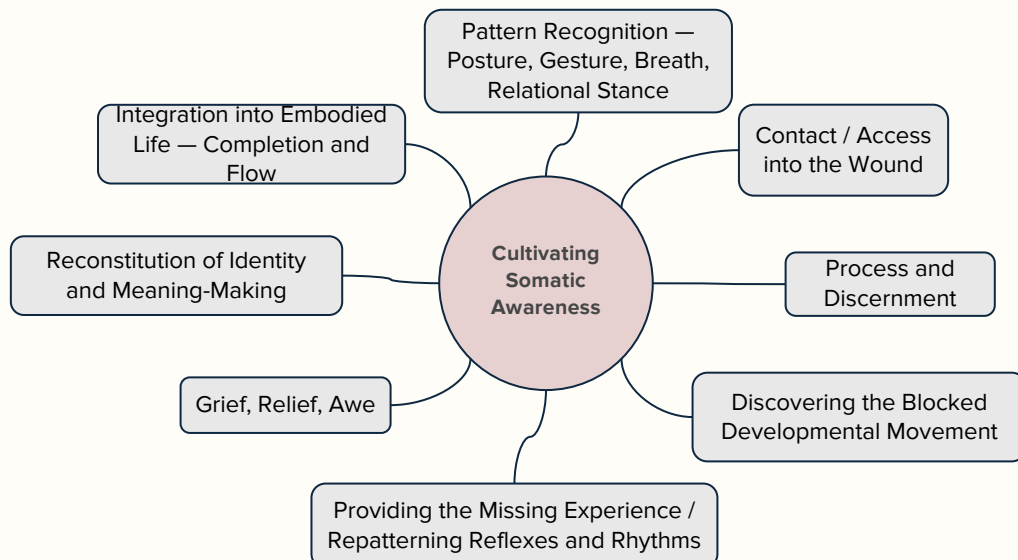
Strengthens positive beliefs that arise during a session (Schwartz & Maiberger, 2018).

- Is there one positive thing you learned today about yourself take with you from our session?
- *Note: If client has difficulty reflecting on something positive from the session, offer a moment that you witnessed during the session that felt like a new awareness or positive shift as a golden nugget.*
- Notice how you feel in your body when you think of [new awareness or positive shift].
- How could you bring this insight into your life?
- Imagine coping effectively with [specific situation]. Imagine stepping into this scene and how you would handle this situation given this new awareness of yourself. Notice what you're thinking, feeling, and experiencing in your body.
- *Note: If the client reports barriers to integration of this new insight into an area of their life, explore how they might navigate these obstacles in a realistic yet empowered manner.*
- **Place any remaining disturbing images, thoughts, emotions, or body sensations into an imagined container** that can hold these experiences until you return to therapy.

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The 8-Phase Map of Developmental Repair



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Session observation

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Session: The Growth Edge



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Growth Edge

- **Current symptoms:** Fear of being seen/judged by others. Wanting to explore becoming more visible.
- **Goal:** To feel more confident.
- **Relevant History:** Parents divorced when young, abuse history, lack of protection/neglect, recently ended marriage.
- **Strengths & Resilience factors:** Supportive family members, good friends, therapist, engages in movement practices regularly, nervous system aware, strong connection to nature.
- **Focus of session:** inner conflict about being seen and “part that feels pressured to perform”
- **Interventions:** Somatic Therapy, Matching the Shape of Body to Fear/Obstacle and Growth Edge, Co-regulation

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Part 1: Arriving Practice

- **Co-Regulation:**
 - Orienting and Arriving
 - The camera and “viewers” are part of this process.
- **5-point Check-In:**
 - Mind, body, breath, emotions, energy



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Part 2: Focus for the Session

Setting the focus for the session:

- Working with part that wants to be seen/take up space & part that feels “clenched”
- “The dichotomy between comfort and risk”

Parts Work:

- Part of me wants to be seen/known
- Part of me wants to stay safe

The Growth Edge:

- “Just the right next emerging shape”

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Part 3: Deepening with Breath and Movement

Pacing the Process:

- Moving Slowly
- Titration and Pendulation between “comfort & opening shapes”

Co-Regulation:

- “Is it okay that I saw that?” “You get to see yourself with it first”
- Averting my Gaze/Closing my eyes
- Relational Resourcing: “I feel grateful for your pacing”

Therapeutic Yoga/Somatic Therapy:

- The opening across her solar plexus & enhancement of breath
- Spinal movements



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Part 4: Support and Freedom

Applied Polyvagal Theory:

- Naming The “Power of Play” (Sympathetic & Ventral)

Therapeutic Yoga/Somatic Therapy:

- Spiral Movement
- Sense of flow “Freedom of movement”

Cognitive Integration:

- “A different way to make the transition than how you thought you were going to do this.”
- Old Belief: “Pressure to perform” New Belief: “I get to be connected to myself.”
- A sense of “support and freedom at the same time”



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Part 5: Playing at the “Edge”



Therapeutic Yoga/Somatic Therapy:

- Playing as the “Otter”
- Sound “Whoosh”
- Rhythms of expansion and contraction
- Rhythms of Mobilization and Rest

Cognitive Integration:

- New Word, “Freedom”
- Tracking the “rebirth” theme & “Newness”
- A new message around being “too much”
- To not be alone with playfulness

Parts Work:

- What does the Bubbly/Ungrounded/playful part need?
- “For whom was this part “too much?”

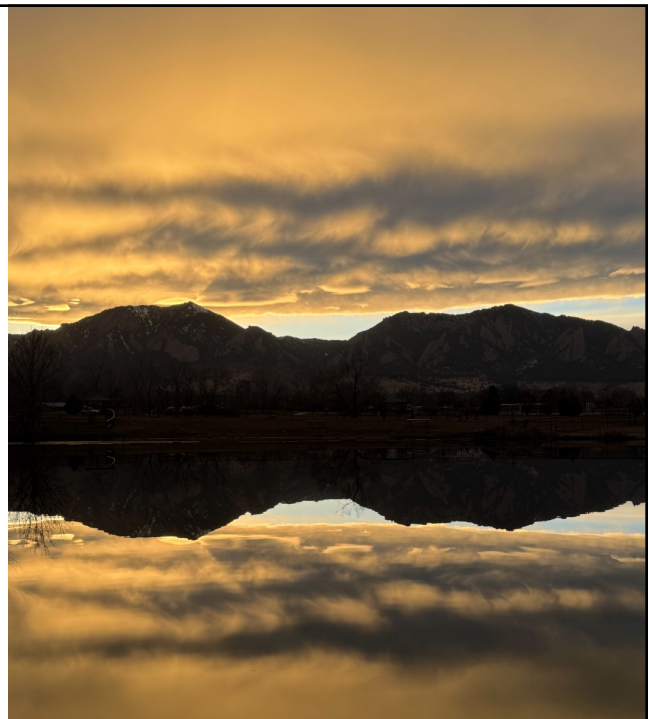
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Part 6: Integration & Closure

- **Therapeutic Yoga/Somatic Integration:**
 - Using the Physio ball
 - Tracking her use of breath
 - Heart opening
- **Golden Nuggets/Cognitive Reappraisal (bridging the session to life):**
 - “I didn’t imagine being this open this soon”
 - “The power of play”
 - “I am accompanied, not doing it by myself”
 - “I can ask for and receive support”



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Journaling Prompts

1. What did you observe in the session demo? What are your takeaways?
2. How might you integrate this session structure into your work?
3. Can you start to see the 8-phase map in the session Demo?

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Stay in Touch

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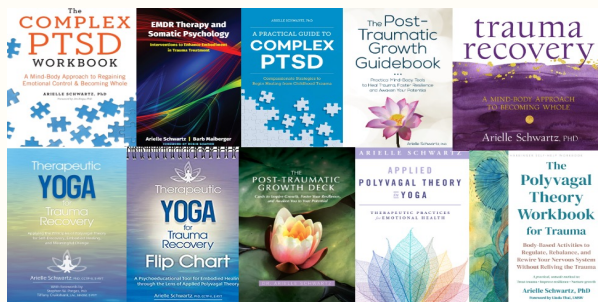
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